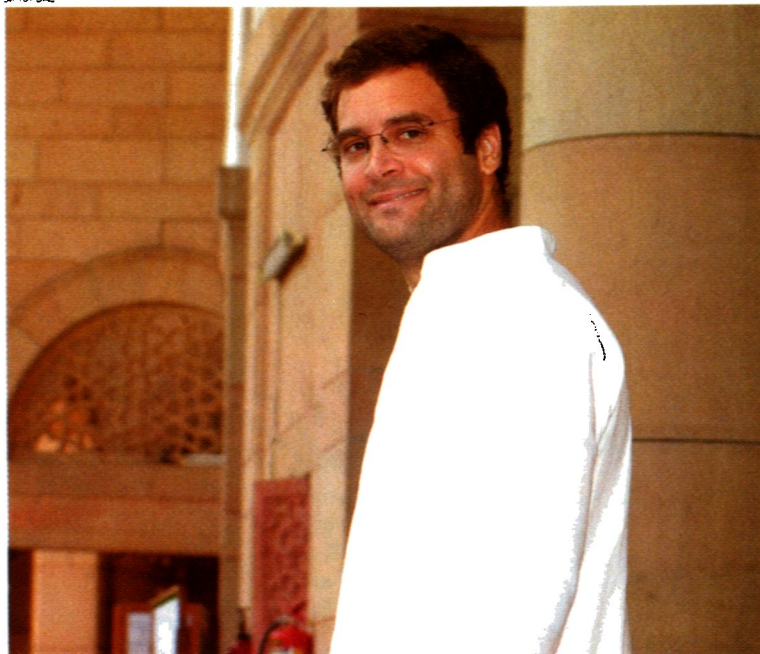


RAHUL GANDHI

37, CONGRESS GENERAL SECRETARY (NEW)

SIPRA DAS



COMING OF AGE

BECAUSE the youngest general secretary of the Congress will be a prime ministerial candidate one day. Because he has started taking an interest in organisational matters. Because the membership to die for in the party is that of his preparatory school, the committee of future challenges, with Digvijay Singh, Veerappa Moily and Prithviraj Chavan on board.

BABA'S DAYS OUT: From watching T-20 matches with Milind Deora to a Rahat Fateh Ali Khan concert with Priyanka and Robert Vadra; from Delhi nightclubs

with an MP's grand-daughter to a night-over at a Dalit's.

TOUGH GUY TALK: "I can't get mummy to take a holiday."

HE IS LEARNING PARAGLIDING, CHECKING OUT THE AERIAL VIEW AFTER TRYING THE GRASSROOTS WAY IN UTTAR PRADESH.

SHARAD PAWAR

67, MINISTER FOR AGRICULTURE (7)

POWER PLAY

BECAUSE no one can ever count him out of the prime ministerial sweepstakes. Because he is the tallest leader in Maharashtra today. Because he has potential allies in both NDA and UPA. Because it was at his initiative that the Left agreed to give the UPA a face-saver on the nuclear deal. Because he heads BCCI, the most influential body in Indian sport and world cricket.

SMART GUY MOVE: Hours after the Congress lost Gujarat to BJP, he dropped in for a casual chat with Shiv Sena chief Bal Thackeray

after nearly a decade.

SHOULD BE EMBARRASSED ABOUT: Over 600 farmer suicides in Vidarbha.



SIPRA DAS

THE DISPLACED

People who didn't make it to the Power List this time



5* M. KARUNANIDHI 84
Chief Minister, Tamil Nadu



6* RAJNATH SINGH 56
President, BJP



9* NITISH KUMAR 57
Chief Minister, Bihar



10* MONTEK AHLUWALIA 64
Deputy Chairman, Plan Panel

* Last year's ranking